If you expect pages of instructions, you'll be happy to know that you can create all of this with just a few clicks using a service called AWS CloudFormation, which you will learn about in detail in chapter 4. AWS CloudFormation does all of the following automatically in the background:

1. Creates a load balancer (ELB)
2. Creates a MySQL database (RDS)
3. Creates a network filesystem (EFS)
4. Creates and attaches firewall rules (security groups)
5. Creates two virtual machines running web servers:
    a. Creates two virtual machines (EC2)
    b. Mounts the network filesystem (EFS)
    c. Installs Apache and PHP
    d. Downloads and extracts the 4.8 release of WordPress
    e. Configures WordPress to use the created MySQL database (RDS)
    f. Starts the Apache web server

To create the infrastructure for your proof of concept, open the AWS Management Console at https://console.aws.amazon.com. Click Services in the navigation bar, and select CloudFormation. You can use the search function to find CloudFormation more easily.

DEFAULT REGION FOR EXAMPLES All examples in this book use N. Virginia (also called us-east-1) as the default region. Exceptions are indicated. Please make sure you switch to the region N. Virginia before starting to work on an example. When using the AWS Management Console, you can check and switch the region on the right side of the main navigation bar at the top.